

Kirsten Ward

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

QA/Testing graduate with 1 year of hands-on experience, most recently at Summit Digital. Comfortable with GitHub Actions and Java, and keen to work somewhere with strong code review culture.

EDUCATION AND TRAINING

Bachelor, Electrical Engineering

Pinehurst University | 2019–2023

CAREER HISTORY

Test Automation Engineer, Summit Digital

2025–2026

- » Integrated automated checks into the GitHub Actions pipeline, blocking 2 faulty releases.
- » Introduced flaky-test quarantine, taking suite reliability from 4% to 94%.
- » Set up cross-browser and device coverage in Java, catching defects staging had missed.
- » Cut end-to-end suite runtime from 6 hours to 6 minutes through parallelisation.

KEY SKILLS

- » GitHub Actions
- » Java
- » Kafka
- » Airflow

OPEN SOURCE

Kafka utility library

Open-source helper library for Kafka, ~100 GitHub stars. Wrote the docs and handled issue triage.

Recipe search engine

Full-text search over a scraped recipe corpus using Java; learned more about ranking than about cooking.

Conference talk

Spoke on Java in production at a regional meetup, ~20 attendees.

TRAINING & CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate — Amazon Web Services, 2024

Databricks Certified Data Engineer Associate — Databricks, 2024

Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-305) — Microsoft, 2016

RESEARCH OUTPUT

"Low-power sensor networks for building monitoring" - co-authored conference paper, 2023.

"Low-power sensor networks for building monitoring" - technical report, 2025. Cited internally as the basis for the current design.

COMMUNITY

Volunteer instructor at a weekend coding club for 12 secondary school students.